It covers these parts and prevents them from dust (Figure 8.10).



Figure 8.10 Face plate

Pedal

It is made up of iron. It is pressed by foot to give pressure for the work of sewing machine. Pedal is found in leg operating machines which is connected to fly wheel through a belt.

8.3 OPERATING THE SEWING MACHINE

All sewing machines have a booklet (manual) which explains the parts of the machine and method of operating the machine. It is important to carefully read and understand it before actually using the sewing machine.

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The points to remember, while stitching in a basic sewing machine

- First sit in a comfortable position on a suitable stool or chair in front of a machine.
- Learn to move your foot carefully at steady speed.
- Move the fly wheel and simultaneously move the legs. Pedal slowly and continuously to get hand and leg coordination.
- In case of electrical sewing machine move the foot or hand to press the electric motor.
- Practice stitching along straight and curved lines without threading.
- Select thread and needles based upon the fabric. For thin and delicate fabrics, fine threads and smaller size needles are selected whereas for thicker fabric, thick and larger size needles are best.

DO YOU KNOW? When was electric sewing machine invented?

The first electric machines were developed by Singer Sewing Co. and introduced in 1889. By the end of the First World War, Singer was offering hand, treadle and electric machines for sale.



Electric Sewing Machine

- Bobbin winding is an important concept in sewing which has to be done with great care. Bobbin is placed on bobbin holder near the fly wheel. Thread is gently pulled from the thread and rolled upon the spool pin and passed through the thread guide. Thread is later wound on the bobbin by rotating the fly wheel.
- When the needle in the machine becomes blunt, it needs to be changed. For changing the needle, the take up lever has to be raised to its highest point and the needle clamp screw has to be loosened. This will remove the old needle. The new needle has to be fixed. The machine needle has a flat side with short groove and a round side with long

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